

An Ghráinseach Nua

Newgrange

Passage tomb · *Tuama pasáiste*

Meath · *An Mhí* · ME019-045----- · 53.69473° N, 6.47554° W · ITM 700676 E, 772749 N



Scan for the live map

Access *Rochtain*

Access is **only by guided tour from the Brú na Bóinne Visitor Centre**, with a shuttle bus to the monument, and **pre-booking is essential**. Do not drive to the monument itself. The tour includes the chamber.

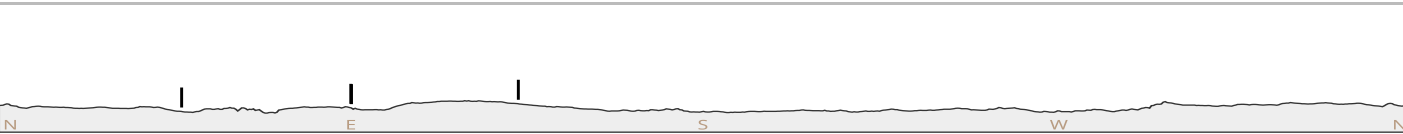
Status as of: Heritage Ireland (OPW), checked Oct 2026.

Next solstices and equinoxes *Grianstaid agus cónochtaí*

Event	Date	Sunrise (flat)	Over the real horizon
December solstice <i>Grianstad an gheimhridh</i>	21 Dec 2026	08:41	08:51 · 133°
March equinox <i>Cónocht an earraigh</i>	20 Mar 2027	06:29	06:33 · 90°
June solstice <i>Grianstad an tsamhraidh</i>	21 Jun 2027	04:55	04:57 · 47°
September equinox <i>Cónocht an fhómhair</i>	23 Sept 2027	07:12	07:17 · 90°

Irish time. Flat = Sun's upper edge on a sea-level horizon (Astronomy Engine). Real horizon = the Sun's upper edge clearing the computed skyline, with azimuth from true north.

The real horizon *An fhíor-léaslíne*



Horizon all round (height ×8). The gold ticks are the sunrise points for the dates above.

The skyline here is computed from the Copernicus 30 m surface model, which includes trees and buildings. The highest point of the horizon is **1.2°** at 120°, and the ground is at about 57 m. At the December solstice the Sun clears the real horizon about **10 min after** the textbook (flat) sunrise. Treat these times as indicative: a field survey would differ.

Claim and evidence *Éileamh agus fianaise*

Claim. The roof-box above the entrance admits the rising Sun at the winter solstice, sending a beam along the 19 m passage to the chamber floor.

Evidence. O'Kelly witnessed it on 21 Dec 1969: first light 8.58 GMT, cut off at 9.15 (17 minutes). Patrick (1974) and Ray (1989) surveyed it; Ray judged the roof-box 'very probably designed'. NMS photography in 2020–21 recorded direct sunlight in the chamber from 12 Dec to 8 Jan, i.e. about 18–20 days either side of the solstice, for under 20 minutes each morning.

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